AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION



The Vault

Secrets, Credentials & Password Security Tools

17	253,943	88%	14
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of **Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 438 curated free tools across 14 realms.

CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

17	15	253,943	14	20,362	2011
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Where secrets live and leak — find them before attackers do, and keep the new ones safe.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

This realm of secrets and credential security tools shows high maturity, with 17 free tools, 15 hosted on GitHub, and a combined 253,943 stars, 14 of which received code pushes in 2026. The star distribution reveals a well-established field: top tools HashiCorp Vault (36.4k stars, 2015), gitleaks (30.0k stars, 2018), KeePassXC (29.3k stars, 2016), trufflehog (28.5k stars, 2016), and hashcat (27.0k stars, 2015) all hold comparable, large followings, indicating no single dominant tool. A notable trend is the consolidation of secret scanning functionality, with gitleaks and trufflehog—two of the most starred tools—being increasingly adopted together to cover both pre-commit and post-commit secret detection workflows.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX (GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES)



● MIT **3** ● Apache-2.0 **3** ● GPL **2** ● Other/none **7**

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2011**; the youngest joined in **2022**. **14/15** GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the remainder are stable classics or web services rather than abandoned picks.

01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS



QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

LaZagne

02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

01

HashiCorp Vault

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

github.com/hashicorp/vault

ACTIVE 2026

★ 36.4k GITHUB STARS	4.8k FORKS	2015 FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10 LAST PUSH	NOASSERTION LICENSE	Go LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A tool for secrets management, encryption as a service, and privileged access management"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the enterprise secrets platform: dynamic credentials, PKI, encryption-as-a-service. (source-available BSL)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs YEARS ON GITHUB	4790 FORKS (REUSE)	— OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #1 by adoption

02

gitleaks

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

github.com/gitleaks/gitleaks

ACTIVE 2026

★ 30.0k	2.3k	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-09	**MIT**	**Go**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1



THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Find secrets with Gitleaks 🔑"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

fast git-history secret scanning from pre-commit hooks to CI; the default choice for repos.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	2317	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 KeePassXC

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

github.com/keepassxreboot/keepassxc

ACTIVE 2026

★ 29.3k	2.0k	2016
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**NOASSERTION**	**C++**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"KeePassXC is a cross-platform community-driven port of the Windows application "KeePass Password Safe"."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

cross-platform, offline, no-cloud password manager — the security-community standard.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10 yrs	1956	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 **trufflehog**

github.com/trufflesecurity/trufflehog

ACTIVE 2026

★ 28.5k	2.6k	2016
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**AGPL-3.0**	**Go**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Find, verify, and analyze leaked credentials"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

deep secret scanning across git, S3, Docker images and 800+ detector types with live credential verification.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10 yrs	2644	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #4 by adoption

github.com/hashcat/hashcat

ACTIVE 2026

★ 27.0k	3.6k	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**—**	**C**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"World's fastest and most advanced password recovery utility"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the world's fastest password-recovery tool; the standard for authorized password-strength audits.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	3578	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 age

github.com/FiloSottile/age

ACTIVE 2026

★ 23.9k	679	2019
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-08	**BSD-3-Clause**	**Go**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A simple, modern and secure encryption tool (and Go library) with small explicit keys, no config options, and UNIX-style composability."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

simple, modern, opinionated file-encryption tool for the post-GPG era.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



7 yrs	679	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #6 by adoption

github.com/getsops/sops

★ 23.4k	1.1k	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**MPL-2.0**	**Go**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Simple and flexible tool for managing secrets"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

encrypted secrets in git: edit YAML/JSON values, commit ciphertext, rotate keys.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	1099	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #7 by adoption

08

Bitwarden

github.com/bitwarden/server

★ 20.4k	1.8k	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**NOASSERTION**	**C#**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Bitwarden infrastructure/backend (API, database, Docker, etc)."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source, sync-everywhere password management for teams and families.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	1801	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #8 by adoption

08 John the Ripper

github.com/openwall/john

★ 13.8k GITHUB STARS	2.6k FORKS	2011 FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10 LAST PUSH	NOASSERTION LICENSE	C LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"John the Ripper jumbo - advanced offline password cracker, which supports hundreds of hash and cipher types, and runs on many operating systems, CPUs, GPUs, and even some FPGAs"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic password auditor: hundreds of hash formats and the legendary jumbo community build.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



15 yrs YEARS ON GITHUB	2564 FORKS (REUSE)	— OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #9 by adoption

10

LaZagne

github.com/AlessandroZ/LaZagne

★ 11.0k GITHUB STARS	2.1k FORKS	2015 FIRST DEVELOPED
2025-09 LAST PUSH	LGPL-3.0 LICENSE	Python LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Credentials recovery project"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

audits which passwords your workstations remember — browsers, mail clients, OS stores — for authorized inventory and exposure checks only.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs YEARS ON GITHUB	2125 FORKS (REUSE)	— OPEN ISSUES	quiet 2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #10 by adoption

11 detect-secrets

github.com/Yelp/detect-secrets

★ 4.7k	575	2017
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-04	**Apache-2.0**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"An enterprise friendly way of detecting and preventing secrets in code."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

enterprise secret scanner designed for baseline diffs and incremental CI audits.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9 yrs	575	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #11 by adoption

12 **noseyparker**

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/praetorian-inc/noseyparker

ARCHIVED

★ 2.3k	132	2022
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-02	**Apache-2.0**	**Rust**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Nosey Parker is a command-line tool that finds secrets and sensitive information in textual data and Git history."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

blazing-fast secret scanning built for huge codebases and full-history sweeps.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



4 yrs	132	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #12 by adoption

13 hardened_malloc

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/GrapheneOS/hardened_malloc

★ 2.0k	167	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**MIT**	**C**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Hardened allocator designed for modern systems. It has integration into Android's Bionic libc and can be used externally with musl and glibc as a dynamic library for use on other Linux-based platforms. It will gain more portability/integration over time."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the allocator that makes exploitation harder by design; from the GrapheneOS project.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	167	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #13 by adoption

14 keyFinder

github.com/momenbasel/keyFinder

★ 725	127	2019
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-07	**MIT**	**JavaScript**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Passive API key and secret discovery browser extension for Chrome and Firefox. 80+ detection patterns, zero config."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

passively discovers leaked API keys and secrets in web pages during browsing.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



7 yrs	127	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #14 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists

half-page dossiers · 100+ stars each

The realm's mid-tier: proven, community-adopted tools that either power specific niches or are climbing fast. Same live-census treatment — two profiles per page.

15 Retraced (BoxyHQ)

github.com/retracedhq/retraced

★ 451	35	2016	2026-08	Apache-2.0	TypeScript
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🔥 A fully open source audit logs service and embeddable UI easily deployed to your own Kubernetes cluster. Brought to you by replicated.com and boxyhq.com 🚀"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source audit-log API: compliant, tamper-evident activity records for your SaaS.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Vault · realm rank #15 by adoption

03 Full Inventory

17 entries · every curated tool

Every entry from the heaven list, carrying its live census chips: stars, first release, 2026 activity, license and language. Rising stars and web-native services included.

GPL-3.0

Metadata Anonymisation Toolkit v2: strips hidden metadata from documents, images and more.

0xacab.org/jvoisin/mat2

Databunker

GPL-3.0

encrypted personal-data vault: API-first storage for PII with built-in privacy compliance.

databunker.org/

04 Realm Directory

17 curated entries · A–Z

- age
- Bitwarden
- Databunker
- detect-secrets
- gitleaks
- hardened_malloc
- hashcat
- HashiCorp Vault
- John the Ripper
- KeePassXC
- keyFinder
- LaZagne
- MAT2
- noseyparker
- Retraced (BoxyHQ)
- SOPS
- trufflehog

FEATURED PRODUCT — BY THE HEAVEN CURATOR

2MNY Website Vulnerability Scanner

Self-hosted website protection suite with 280+ deterministic scanner modules — OWASP Top 10, WordPress/CMS deep scans, subdomain takeover, AI-stack exposure, CVSS evidence reports. The production platform that curates this heaven list.

CONTINUE THE TOUR — OTHER REALM DOSSIERS

⚔️ The Armory · 🛡️ The Bastion · 🔭 The Watchtower · 🗺️ The Cartographers · 🕵️ The Shadow Bureau · 🐬 The Foundry · 🔵 The Sentinel Ops · 🤖 The Oracle's Domain · 🧠 The AI Forge · 🆓 The Free Bazaar · 🎓 The Academy · 🎯 The Proving Grounds · 🛠️ The Workshop